Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements Baltics

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QMS Area:	Quality
QMS Chapter:	4.9 Product Safety, Product Quality and Pharmacovigilance

Applicability

Bayer Level:	CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit ☒ PH ☒ CH

GBS Location
☐ Global Business Services Barcelona
☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil
☐ Global Business Services Manila
☒ Global Business Services Gdansk
☐ Global Business Services India
☐ Global Business Services Dalian
☐ Global Business Services Germany

Region/ Country
☐ Global
☒ Specific Country: Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania

Relevance for R&D QMS
☐ Affected
☐ Interface
☒ N/A

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Relevant Process and Activities:	PTC

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1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Service in process steps like complaint initiation, classification forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final approval including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This SOP defines clear guidance to the Global Business Service regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This SOP is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CMO	Contract Manufacturing Organization
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Service
OTC products	Over-the-counter products
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit

3 Purpose & Set-Up

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for Estonia, Latvia and Lithuania are described in this SOP, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Service all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of Global Business Services follow the SOP during complaint processing in the complaint database on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

GBS team	- Enters PTCs, Suspected Counterfeit Incidents and Usability Issues according to defined timelines in a timely manner, entering them into the global complaint database in English language - Organizes missing information and asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language) - Performs the initial intake of complaints after receipt - Informs the CQU about all PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential counterfeits and any other cases described in this SOP - Informs the respective PV about all PTCs with a potential associated AE or LODE or potentially reportable medical device complaints, including the unique complaint database number and all relevant follow-up information - Forwards the case to the respective RQU for further assessment - Initiates the process of sample shipment if requested by RQU or specified in any other guidance document - Reviews the case for plausibility and closes the complaint case in complaint database - Supports the process for reimbursement management - Forwards all cases that are not PTCs back to the CQU or to the appropriate function for further processing
Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU)	- Is responsible for regular KPI evaluation to get overview of complaint activities at the GBS - Supports the GBS in organizing missing complaint information - Translates Lithuanian, Estonian, Latvian complaints into English and sends them to GBS (if applicable) - Supports the GBS PTC and/ or Customer Service Teams with organizing the complaint sample retrieval and shipment of it to the RQU if requested. - Sends out the Response Letters to the complainants as requested and agreed with the GBS - Ensures that all changes within the country law and regulation are directly notified to the GBS and that the Country Specific SOP is updated - Ensures that the current list of distributed products is updated and contains all products.

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4.1.1 General Information

In the Baltics countries the Bayer company operates under legal entities:

- UAB Bayer,
  Sporto str. 18, Vilnius
  LT- 09238
  Lithuania

- SIA Bayer
  Skanstes street 50
  Riga, LV 1013
  Latvia

- Bayer OÜ Estonia
  Lõõtsa 12
  Tallinn 1141
  Estonia

The CQH Baltics is based in Vilnius, Lithuania.

4.1.2 Contact list

GBS PTC Team generic address email address: *ptc.lt@bayer.com*

Coutry Quality Head Baltics:
Irena Tumalaviciene - *irena.tumalaviciene@bayer.com*

Back-ups of the CQH Baltics –
Daiva Cekanauskaite - *daiva.cekanauskaite-kairevice@bayer.com*
Vilma Pukeleviciene – *vilma.pukeleviciene@bayer.com*

Customers/ other Wholesalers from three Baltic countries are sending complaints directly to Customer Service team to email box: *customerservice.baltic@bayer.com*

Complaints also can be sent directly to generic quality e-mail address: *quality.baltics@bayer.com*. The same address can be used for internal communication between Baltic countries team and GBS PTC Team.

Information about IUS usability issues (IUS replacement) for Latvia, Estonia and/or Lithuania are forwarded via “Medical Replacement Assistant” - digital IUS replacement system. Additional information in the countries can be requested from:

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
Customer Engagement Manager Latvia – *eva.zelve-dombrovska@bayer.com* Medical and Customer Engagement Manager Estonia – *andres.paabos@bayer.com* Key Customer Engagement Specialist – *danute.aidukonyte-sidaraviciene@bayer.com* **Remark:** Current name and e-mail address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list*	
4.1.3 Escalation Rules The CQH and the CQH deputy should be notified via notification in the complaint database about any complaint case referring to at least one of the following situations: - Suspected Counterfeit Cases - Any cases involving Health Authorities - Cases with final risk category high or medium (escalation via immediate action) **Remark:** The current names and e-mail addresses of the CQH and the CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list*	GBS
4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases If a complaint case is related to any type of Adverse Event, the Pharmacovigilance department has to be informed via the following e-mail address. *PV.nordics@bayer.com*	GBS
4.1.5 Product Samples The contact person at Customer Services function is responsible for gathering information about samples availability and for sample acquisition. If a sample is declared to be available, the complainant is requested to send it to Bayer local stock/warehouse in Lithuania or directly to lead investigation units (RQU) at the specified address. In case of absence of samples, Customer Service provides the GBS with the reason. The GBS PTC officer specifies the result of requests and the time points in “Immediate Actions” field in the complaint database. This applies to all Baltic countries. Samples are sent to the RQU via courier service from local Bayer warehouse. In the same way, when possible, directly from complainant. **E-mail address for contact person at Customer Service function:** *customersevice.baltic@bayer.com*	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.6 Statement letter **Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in:** Acknowledgement letter, that the complaint received, is sent by the contact responsible person at Customer Service function. **Response Letter after closing:** The CQH is responsible for providing the response to the complainant via Customer Service function, if requested. In Lithuania the response letter is prepared in local language according to local legislation requirements. Standard response message is provided and sent out by contact person from Customer Service function without involvement of the CQH. If response is required regarding IUS (intrauterine systems) replacement UI (usability issue) or PTC/PTC+AE cases in Lithuania, Latvia and Estonia, it is prepared in local languages by Medical and/or Customer Engagement Manager/ Specialist (depends on the country) and are sent by them to the complainant. The response does not contain any copy of the company complaint data base.	GBS
4.1.7 RQU Contact list A table with all available products in the country, needed for entry into the complaint database, is available on SharePoint: go/ptcops. For CH products registration status in the respective country as well as Manufacturing Site are available via SYNAPS: go/synaps. List with the respective RQU contact names are provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint: PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx* CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*	GBS
4.1.8 List of Local Opportunities Products *N/A*	
4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements Lithuania, Latvia, Estonia and Poland are members of the European Union, follows the rules of the same EU GDPR act, hence there is no restrictions in data flow. Every e-mail should contain data privacy statement.	
4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) Baltic countries have on average less than 100 complaints per year per country. Therefore, they are classified as micro language countries. Translation of IUD PTC and PTC+AE into English is performed by the Medical or Product marketing function (from Lithuanian, Latvian or Estonian). Additional	GBS CQU

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
information, if needed, is also gathered by the Medical Managers and forwarded translated into English to the GBS PTC Team. IUS usability issues cases are receive translated as notification via „Medical Replacement Assistant" - digital IUS replacement system (see Chapter 4.1.14). Customer Service team receives complaints from customers (other wholesalers from Baltic countries) and for future actions - registration in the complaint database - sends them in English to GBS and cc. to the CQH.	
4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement Reimbursement for a product is granted, when the sample is declared as available and delivered to Bayer warehouse. Products are delivered through the reverse supply chain by the wholesalers and pharmacies. If a product is returned to the warehouse, reimbursement is managed by the Supply Chain/ Customer Service, who issues a credit note to the customer.	GBS, Customer Service
4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translations N/A	GBS
4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases **Complaints received via phone call:** Complaints may also come via phone to the Baltic offices to the reception desk. Such complaints should be entered in English by the phone call receiver to the PTC complaint form (Annex 1) and forwarded to GBS PTC Team and cc. to CQH Baltics. **MedInfo** MedInfo (using the generic address *mi.baltic@bayer.com*) sends all suspected PTC reports to PTC GBS Gdansk. An automatic autoresponder is sent back from the GBS PTC Team inbox to acknowledge the receipt of the report.	
4.1.14 Others The GBS notifies the CQH and/or Customer Service about each case closure via e-mail for further processing. The notification contains the complaint ID and the result of final RQU conclusion without any copies out of the complaint data base. Regarding IUS PTC and PTC+AE cases, the GBS also notifies the respective Medical and/ or Product marketing function in the respective countries and cc. CQH about the closure of the case and the relevant complaint ID. The notification of the closure of the case enables the Customer Service function to send a response message to the complainant (if requested). **IUS replacement system** In Baltic Countries, there is a digital IUS replacement system „Medical Replacement Assistant" that allows physicians to submit a replacement application in case of failed insertion of the IUS.	

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
Within the system, once HCP submits the application, e-mail is sent to PTC mailbox with all the details HCP has added in the form. Application comes in with reference number that PTC Officer enters it in the complaint database. After registering case in the complaint database, the complaint ID should be added into the digital IUS replacement system. The system can be accessed using the following link: *https://mra.bayer.com*.	

5 Internal References

- SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”

6 External References

- N/A

History of changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective Date *(yyyy-mm-dd)*
1	New document	2020-07-13
2	n/a	2020-08-24
3	# Chapter 3.3 CQH translation responsibilities updated # Chapter 4.1.2 Customer Service Baltics email adress added # Chapter 4.1.5 Sample handling method (direct shipment from the complainant) added # Chapter 4.1.6 Possibility of response to the customer by marketing Bayer department added # Chapter 4.1.10 Customer Service Baltics responsibilities added. # Chapter 4.1.10 Local specific case number addition to Dev@Com case removed - not applicable # Chapter 4.1.10 Described how to use Annex 1 for CQU to forward the complaint received by phone #Annex 1 added	2022-01-14
4	#Document text: changed SSC and SSCDN references to GBS, SCG to GBS Gdansk # Whole document text - text mistakes and grammar corrections # Chapter 2 Abbreviations section updated # Chapter 3.3 Roles and responsibilities updated # Chapter 4.1.1 Bayer addresses updated # Chapter 4.1.2 Contact list emails addresses updated # Chapter 4.1.3 Escalation rules updated # Chapter 4.1.4 PV local email address updated # Chapter 4.1.5 Customer Service function role in sample retrieval/shipment process added # Chapter 4.1.6 Role of Customer Service for acknowledgement letter added Response letter rules updated # Chapter 4.1.9 Guidelines for Data Privacy Requirements updated # Chapter 4.1.10 Gathering information and translation rules updated. Role of Customer Service function added # Chapter 4.1.13 Medical Information role as reporter added. An automatic response from PTC Team added.	2023-10-25
5	# Updated according to SSC-PTC-BP-002 “Country specific SOP template” version 5.0 # Chapter 4.1.2 Contact list updated # Chapter 4.1.10 Gathering additional information updated # Chapter 4.1.14 Others updated (due to implementation of IUS replacement system and organization changes in the BAL)	2024-11-29

6	# Updated according to SSC-PTC-BP-002 v.6.0 Country Specific SOP template # Roles and responsibilities updated based on SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0 # Complaint database system name updated from “Dev@com” to “complaint database” due to change of the complaint database system # Chapter 4.1.2 Contact list updated # Chapter 4.1.3 Escalation rules: escalation on initial risk category removed, escalation regarding final risk categories changed to high and medium according to SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0 # Chapter 4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements updated	See Coversheet

7 Annex 1

Product Complaint Form

Complaint created (date)……
Complaint received (date) ……

Product information:	
Product name	
Batch / lot number	
Dosage form *(cream, tablet, capsule, etc.)*	
Package type/size	
Number of packages	
Sample available?*	Yes/No
*Sample available = please keep for further potential shipment	

Complaint information:	
Complaint description (defect description, is it suspected counterfeit case, etc.)	
Adverse event reported?	Yes/No
Does the complainant expect a response from Bayer?**	
**By requesting a response, the Complainant agrees to his/hers contact data being processed by Bayer for the purpose of providing the answer to the submitted complaint *(the exact sounding to be aligned with legal)*	

Complainants' contact information attention: in the countries with special Data Privacy regulations to be replaced by the complainant code number (to be given by CQU)	
Name and surname	
E-mail address	
Telephone	
Home address	

Sender (if other than Complainant, e.g. a pharmacy)	
Senders' Name (Legal entity)	
Address	
E-Mail address	
Telephone number	

Any additional information	

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